Memo: three levers to grow bound commission before the next raise

To: Founders · From: Pavitra Seth (applicant, Founder's Office) · November 2026 · Based on simulated data in github.com/f20220970-debug/soma-brokerage-ops-lab

THE ASK

Approve three experiments over the next 60 days, in this order: **an AI agent that answers after-hours leads**, **appetite-based carrier routing**, and **proactive reviews for renewals facing a rate increase**. Together they target the biggest leaks in the funnel without adding lead spend.

WHY NOW

In an illustrative growth plan, the business reaches USD 10M ARR in month 20 but runs out of cash in month 19: costs scale with leads every month, while commission arrives slowly as the book builds. Converting more of the leads we already pay for is the cheapest way to close that gap.

WHAT THE SIMULATION SUGGESTS

Lever	Problem today	Simulated effect	Cost
AI first response after hours	38% of leads arrive after hours and wait a median 4.5 hours	+13.7% policies bound	Agent running cost; no new headcount
Carrier routing by appetite	Applications go to carriers unlikely to quote that industry	Bind rate 49% → 61%; first quote 0.5 days sooner	Appetite table, refreshed monthly
Renewal review before rate rises	Renewal falls from 88% to 62% when the rate rises more than 15%	+6.8 pts renewal	Account-manager time on the policies at risk

These numbers come from a simulation with stated assumptions, not from Soma's data. Their job is to rank the levers and size the tests, not to forecast results.

HOW I WOULD RUN IT

1. **Week 1–2: measure the real baseline.** Rebuild the funnel from production data (lead → contacted → applied → quoted → bound) by channel, state and hour, and reconcile it with finance.
2. **Week 3–6: after-hours AI response.** Switch the agent on in alternate weeks, state by state, so each state is compared with itself. Guardrails: claims and cancellations always go to a human, and a weekly hand-labelled sample of 100 messages checks the agent's accuracy for drift.
3. **Week 5–8: carrier routing.** A 50/50 split by application. Success means a higher bind rate and fewer days to first quote, with no rise in declines.
4. **Ongoing: renewal reviews.** Randomise reviews among renewals facing an increase of more than 10%, so the effect is measured, not assumed.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE MY MIND

- If after-hours leads convert poorly *even when answered fast*, the gap is lead quality, not speed. Fix channels before automating.
- If carriers' appetite shifts faster than monthly, routing needs live quote/decline data rather than a fixed table.
- If the agent's weekly accuracy check falls below 90% on intents it handles alone, it goes back to drafting replies for a human to send.

ONE PAGE OF METRICS I WOULD BRING EVERY MONDAY

New annualised commission bound · % of leads answered in under 5 minutes, day and night · applications with at least one quote · days to first quote · renewal rate for the last 90 days · share of messages auto-handled and the agent's accuracy on the weekly sample.

Supporting work: live growth and runway planner (soma-growth-console on Streamlit) · daily-evaluated AI triage agent (f20220970-debug.github.io/llm-triage-agent) · ARR model in Excel (github.com/f20220970-debug/arr-growth-model). All figures are simulated or illustrative.